

Redesign the Misleading Colored Chart

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Chart 1 – Headcount by Department

1. What is this chart trying to show?

The chart is a **bar chart showing the number of employees (headcount) in different departments** of an organization. It compares the number of employees working in departments such as **Sales, Marketing, Engineering, HR, and Finance**. The height of each bar represents the number of employees in that particular department. By looking at the chart, we can easily compare which department has the highest and lowest number of employees.

2. What's wrong with the color choice?

The main problem is that **different shades of blue are used for every bar**, even though all the bars represent the same type of information—employee headcount. The different colors can make the viewer think that each department belongs to a different category or that some departments are more important than others. The color variation also adds unnecessary visual distraction and makes the chart less consistent.

3. Propose a better color scheme. (Describe in words)

A better color scheme would be to **use the same color for all departments**, such as a single medium-blue color. This would make it clear that all departments are being compared using the same measurement. If we want to highlight a particular department, we can use one contrasting color only for that department and keep the remaining bars in the same blue color. This would make the chart cleaner, simpler, and easier to understand.

Chart 2 – Attendance by Class

1. What is this chart trying to show?

The chart is a **bar chart showing the attendance percentage of students in different classes**. It compares attendance levels among classes such as **Class A, Class B, Class C, Class D, and Class E**. The height of each bar represents the attendance level of the particular class. The chart helps us quickly identify which class has the **highest attendance and which class has the lowest attendance**.

2. What's wrong with the color choice?

The chart uses **several different colors for the bars**, even though all the bars represent the same measurement, which is attendance. This makes the chart visually confusing because the colors may suggest that the classes belong to different groups or categories. The use of many colors also creates unnecessary visual complexity and makes it harder for the viewer to focus on the actual attendance values.

3. Propose a better color scheme. (Describe in words)

A better approach would be to use **one consistent color for all classes**, such as blue, because all classes are being compared using the same attendance measurement. If the purpose is to identify a particular class with unusually high or low attendance, that class can be highlighted using a different contrasting color. The remaining classes should use the same color. This will make the chart **clearer, more professional, and easier to compare**.